

1. FUNDAMENTAL RULES

1.1 Boat Type.

- New designs must be approved at least 18 months in advance in writing by Atlantic Campaigns (AC). To submit a new design email us on - info@atlanticcampaigns.com

1.2 Permitted Designs.

- Rannoch Adventure
 - R45, R45 Elite, RX45 (Trio, Fours and Fives)
 - R35 (Pairs and Trios)
 - R25, RX25 (Solos and Pairs)
- Ocean Rowing Company
 - D34 (Trio, Fours and Fives)
 - D12 (Solos and Pairs)
 - DOR12¹ (Pair Only)
 - DOR34² (Trio, Fours and Fives)
- Rossiter's³
 - Ocean 2 (Pairs, Trios and Fours)
 - Ocean 3 (Trio, Fours and Fives)
- Adkins⁴
 - Pair (Pairs only)
- Leven Brown Adventures⁵
 - LB4 (Pairs and Trios)

Crews shall compete for the following trophies:

- Fastest crew/Overall race winner.
- Fastest women's crew.

1.3 Clearance to Participate.

- No individual boat shall start until all criteria have been met and signed off by the Race Organisers.

1.4 Crew Size.

- All boats shall be raced with the correct number of crew on board. This is dictated by vessel design.
- Crews that have a member evacuated may continue if deemed safe to do so by AC. An emergency evacuation by a non-AC vessel may require all crew to abandon the boat if instructed by the skipper of the assisting vessel.
- A crew that takes another person on board will not get a race place and the crossing will be deemed assisted. This may only occur if deemed safe by AC.

¹ Only the boat known as Miss Universe for as long as she remains in the possession of an AC crew.

² Only the boats known as Little Swiss Lady and Heidi for as long as they remain in the possession of an AC crew.

³ Pre 2018 boats only, built by Rossiters.

⁴ Until 2025 World's Toughest Row – Atlantic only

⁵ Only the boat known as Melokuhle, for as long as she remains in the possession of an AC crew.

1.5 Mandatory Equipment.

Each team shall carry:

- Race and safety equipment as specified within the Mandatory Equipment List (Appendix 1).
- Additional items may be carried if they conform to these rules and are approved by AC.
- When doubt exists, the competitor shall obtain written clarification from the race organiser.

1.6 Other Means of Propulsion.

- The boat shall only be propelled by the rowing effort of the crew and the natural action of the wind, waves and currents acting on the boat whilst operating in their normal manner and their intended function.
- There shall be no use, or attempted use, of any equipment that deliberately reduces rowing effort or increases boat speed, e.g. improvised sail or increasing windage. Any team found in breach of these rules may be disqualified.

Note. Refer to penalties at Para 11.10

1.7 Safety at Sea.

- When at sea all crew members not inside the cabin must be securely attached to the boat's jackstays by an approved harness and safety line at all times. This includes when swimming or cleaning the hull. Handrails are not to be used as the sole point of connection to the boat but may be used in addition to jackstays.
- Cabin hatches are to always remain closed other than for transit to/from cabins.
- There must always be at least 1 person on board the vessel whilst at sea (solos excluded).

Note. Refer to penalties at Para 11.14

2. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

2.1 Emergency Procedure.

- Any emergencies, urgent incidents or problem solving must be dealt with in accordance with the Crisis Ops document. This includes contacting the Safety Officer. This document is to be kept accessible whilst at sea. All competitors are to demonstrate knowledge of the Crisis Ops document as part of the Compliance Inspection (CI). Teams not adhering to this may be disqualified.

2.2 Race Start - Mandatory Equipment.

- All teams shall start the race with all equipment as specified in the Mandatory Equipment List (Appendix 1) on board the boat and demonstrate an understanding of the equipment's, its proper use and its redundancy.
- All equipment shall be installed as specified in the Mandatory Equipment List.
- All equipment shall be available for inspection during the Compliance Inspection, during the pre-race period, and shall be subject to spot checks up to 1 hour before the start.

2.3 Race Finish - Mandatory Equipment.

- With the exception of the food eaten and other mandatory equipment which may be described as consumables, all equipment as per the Mandatory Equipment List (Appendix 1) shall be on the boat at the finish of the race.
- All unused food shall also be on the boat at the finish of the race and available for inspection.
- Crews failing to produce items on request may face disqualification or time/race place penalties.

Note. Refer to penalties at Para 11

2.4 Packaging and Refuse.

- All packaging and refuse shall be retained on board until disposal can be arranged in an appropriate location ashore.
- Crews are to demonstrate an acceptable plan to the SO during the inspection period. Crews not presenting all refuse at the finish may be disqualified.
- Flares that have been set off at the race finish port must be extinguished in a bucket and NOT thrown into the water.

2.5 Post-Race Inspection.

- All boats shall be available for post-race inspection of equipment at a time given by the SO within 24 hours of making landfall.
- Boats will be moved for onward shipping immediately post this inspection.

2.6 Race Tracking.

- The tracking unit shall be fitted to the boats by AC prior to race start and shall remain in the designated position, connected, and switched on for the duration of the race.
- If a boat suspects that the tracking unit is not working, they must advise the SO immediately.
- In the event of loss or malfunction of the tracking unit teams shall relay their position by satellite telephone to the SO every 12 hours or as instructed by the SO.
- If for any reason during the race the tracking unit fails to provide position reports, the race organiser reserves the right to replace the tracking unit without penalty to the boat.
- No boats shall carry a second beacon.
- The YB tracking URL may not be embedded in any individual team/sponsors websites. All followers will be directed to the official race website.

2.7 Satellite Communications.

- All teams shall carry a minimum of three satellite telephones on the Iridium network (to be rented from Range Global Services, with an associated US line to facilitate Skype call) capable of voice calling and sending and receiving text messages. One is for general use and one is only to be used for SO calls only and the third to remain in a sealed waterproof bag in the grab bag for emergency use only.
- Each telephone must have at least one spare battery.
- There must be a means of charging and a secondary means of charging independent of the boats electrical system. This secondary means must be demonstrated as working during the compliance inspection. It can include such items as flexible solar panels, Power Monkey devices and chemical charging units. It does not include pre-charged power banks.
- The satellite telephone must have an external antenna that enables the telephone to be used from inside the cabin without opening any hatch. External antenna cable must pass through the bulkhead.
- The satellite telephone must have an external antenna that is large enough to pick up signal over the solar panels and other antennae.
- Each team shall ensure their satellite telephone is switched on and remains on between 1300 UTC and 1500 UTC every day. This time is for SO calls only. Crews are not to make outgoing calls including calling the SO during this time unless it is an emergency.
- Each team shall carry a BGAN unit provided (to be rented from Range Global Services). Teams are to have WhatsApp installed on their smart devices in order to use the BGAN for back up communications with the SO and for sending photographs/video to aid medical diagnosis or boat/system repair advice. The main vessel whatsapp number is to be shared with the safety team ahead of race start.

- Each team shall carry a Garmin inReach device (Mini 2 or 86i, NOT the Messenger device) on a suitable data plan/subscription, such that they can send and receive daily text messages. The inReach number is to be shared with the safety team ahead of race start.

Note. WhatsApp is not to be used as the default means of communication with the SO and all Emergency comms must be via voice call NOT text message or voice note. Texts will be replied to during duty hours only.

2.8 Medical Kit.

- Each boat shall carry a comprehensive medical kit. The minimum contents are detailed in Appendix 2. The Race Doctor must approve additional items.
- The medical kit must be as specified before arrival in Gomera.
- All competitors shall have sufficient knowledge of the contents and use of the medical kit.
- Any personal medication carried must be declared to the safety team before race start.

2.9 Cabin Hatches.

- The forward and aft cabin access hatches shall be fitted with the hinges located on either the left or right hand side, such that the hatch opens sideways in the athwartships plane and not vertically up and down.
- The hatch window may be manufactured in acrylic or any material of similar strength.
- All hatches must meet ISO 12216 design category A appliance area II standards.
- All hatches must be kept clear for race branding to be applied.

2.10 Hatch Integrity.

- All hatches, both cabin and those fitted in the deck shall be watertight.
- All hatches should be pressure tested.
- Any deck hatches with removable lids shall have the lid attached to the boat with a lanyard to prevent the lid from being lost when open.

2.11 Internal Integrity.

- All internal bulkheads are to be watertight.
- Any ducting is to be adequately sealed to prevent water flowing into connected compartments.

2.12 Solar Panel Fixing.

- Solar panels shall not be elevated, shall be rigidly mounted and flush to the cabin top and shall not overlap or cover the space assigned for the official race branding. (See Appendix 3 – Branding Diagram).

2.13 Wind Generators.

- Wind generators are not permitted.

2.14 Fuel Cells.

- Fuel cells, where fitted, may be used at the discretion of the crew. All fuel cells must be secure and correctly ventilated as per manufacturers specifications. Fuel cells may only be used in addition to solar power and must not be the main source of power.
- Any crews considering fitting a fuel cell should speak to a member of the safety team prior to having the work carried out.

2.15 Electrical Specification.

- All electrical equipment and installations shall conform to the specification as detailed in the electrical section of the mandatory equipment list, Appendix 1 of Race Rules.

2.16 Cooking Gas.

- The gas cooker shall be capable of being securely mounted for cooking outside the cabin.
- Cooking is not to take place inside the cabin.
- Any crew using an alternative heating method, including self-heating food sachets, are to have their food plan agreed in writing by AC a minimum of 2 months prior to their boat being shipped to the start.
- All gas will be supplied by the crew and will be inspected along with the calorie plan during the Compliance Inspection.

2.17 Oars.

- The oars used whilst racing shall be of the approved type and specification as stated in the equipment list.
- The area measurement of the blades shall not exceed 1,530cm².
- Each team must have at least 1 set of new oars at the race start.
- Each boat must carry 1 set of oars per rowing position and a minimum of 1 spare set.

2.18 Awnings.

- Sun awnings/shade of any description shall not be carried or improvised during the race. Use of an awning is a critical safety issue and may result in disqualification.

2.19 Flags.

Each team shall fly:

- Race flag (supplied by the race organiser)
 - National flag (supplied by the race organiser)
- Flags other than those specifically authorised by the race organiser shall not be carried or hoisted during the race. This includes when crossing the finish line. Quarantine and courtesy flags are not required in a race.
- The race flag & national flag shall be hoisted at all times.
- The race flag and the national flag must be hoisted on a flagpole which must be situated on the starboard side of the stern cabin as per the branding diagram. All Rannoch boats must have the standard Rannoch carbon 30" (76cm) flagpole fitted by Rannoch Adventure. All non-Rannoch boats must fit a flagpole the top of which is 1.8m above the waterline and must receive AC approval prior to being installed.

Note. AC reserve the right to retrospectively disqualify any team found to have flown any flags aside from the race flag and the national flag during the race.

2.20 Waypoints.

- All crews must track south of the start waypoint(s) as stipulated in the Start brief given during the Pre-Race Period.
- No boat shall pass between La Gomera and El Hierro. Any boat that passes between La Gomera and El Hierro may be disqualified and returned to La Gomera where they will be liable for their own shipping and repatriation arrangements.
- To assist boats in achieving this, there are one or two 'clearing waypoints', which all boats must have stored in their main and handheld GPS units. The waypoint(s) describe the ends of a line on the chart, which boats must stay south of. Passing North of this line may incur a penalty of 24 hours.

- Further to these waypoint(s), the race organiser may provide one or more additional waypoints, which are for the purpose of keeping boats clear of any weather that may push them north or north-west and could result in them being driven onto land or between the islands. Any such waypoints will be given on the morning of the race start. Rowers are required to note these waypoints and store them in their main GPS unit.
- Once boats are clear of El Hierro, to the south and/or west, they are free to make their own passage to the Finish Line waypoint (supplied during the pre-race period) in English Harbour, Antigua.

2.21 Rudders & Steering.

- All crews must have the ability to replace their rudder with a functional spare at sea and have practiced this during their qualifying training hours.
- All Rannoch boats are to carry a spare tiller stock assembly.
- Minimum 50% of training hours should be carried out under manual steering. (Do not assume auto tillers will make it all the way across.)

3. QUALIFICATION AND DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Rower Documentation.

- All rowers must hold the following certificates:
 - RYA Sea Survival or national equivalent
 - RYA First Aid at Sea or national equivalent
 - RYA Essential Navigation & Seamanship
 - SRC Short Range Radio Licence or national equivalent
 - Ocean Rowing Course

Note. Alternatives and national equivalents are to be signed off in writing by AC prior to completion. Refer to Appendix 5 of Race Rules for a list of preauthorised alternate courses.

3.2 Boat Documentation.

- Each team must upload the following documents to their team One Drive folder by 01 Sept of the year racing is due to commence:
 - Independent structural survey report (including new builds) to be carried out no greater than 6 months prior to race start.
 - Hex ID, evidence of registration and make & model details of 2 EPRIB per boat. Hex ID, evidence of registration, make and model details of 1 PLB per person to be listed in the Boat Comms document in the team One Drive folder.
 - Certificate of packing & servicing of life raft within 6 months of race start.
 - 3 x Satellite phone details (to be supplied by Range Global Services who will inform AC directly).
 - Garmin inReach number
 - SSR or national registration details.
 - Ships Radio Licence (AIS **MUST** match registered vessel name).
 - Proof of qualifying rowing hours completed as per the format provided.
 - Proof of onward vessel shipping from the finish port.

4. EMERGENCY DRINKING WATER, STABILITY, BALLAST AND SELF-RIGHTING

4.1 Emergency Drinking Water.

- All boats shall carry emergency drinking water as stipulated that can be used in an emergency without penalty but only with prior consent of the SO.
5 – 50 LITRES
4 – 40 LITRES
3 – 30 LITRES
2 – 20 LITRES
1 – 15 LITRES
- No emergency drinking water is to be used without prior permission from the SO. Any water used must immediately be replaced by salt water until a point in time that this can be replaced by fresh.
- Penalties shall be applied if any declared water ballast (e.g., Adkins pair) over and above the permitted emergency 50lts is removed or used whilst at sea.

Note. Refer to penalties at Para 11

4.2 Self Righting.

- All boats must be of a design that is proven to self-right.

4.3 Ballast.

- Rannoch boats do not require additional ballast.
- Adkin boats required 100 litres in addition to the emergency drinking water.
- DOR12/D12 & DOR34/D34 do not require additional ballast.
- Ocean 2&3 do not require additional ballast.
- LBA do not require additional ballast.

5. BOAT INSPECTION

5.1 Pre-Shipping Inspection (PSI).

- All boats must have a PSI. AC will organise events where this may take place, usually between June and October on the year of racing that all UK based teams are to attend in person. Non-UK based crews that are unable to attend any of these events are to arrange an inspection remotely.

5.2 Compliance Inspection (CI) Pre- Race, La Gomera.

- All boats shall have an inspection of all mandatory equipment on board within the pre-race period. No boats will be allowed to enter the water without complete sign off from the SOs.

5.3 Post-Race Inspection (PRI), Antigua.

- All boats shall be available for a post-race inspection within 24 hours of arrival in Antigua, prior to preparation for shipping at a given time slot.

6. EXTERNAL ASSISTANCE, MEDIA MATERIALS, RESPONSE VESSELS & TRAINING

6.1 Medical Advice.

- Medical advice provided via VHF, satellite telephone or BGAN shall not be classified as outside assistance. All medical advice must go via the SO and Race Doctor.

6.2 Re-supplies.

- Apart from the use of a watermaker, collection of rainwater or fishing, a boat shall not receive any re-supplies/**gift/good will gesture, whether requested or offered**, of food, drink or equipment during the race.

Note. Refer to penalties at Para 11

6.3 Safety Intervention.

- If the race organiser deems that a boat is at risk of running out of water, food or likely to require additional medical supplies at a later time, the race organiser reserves the right to provide such assistance to a boat for reasons of safety.
- Each situation shall be judged on a case-by-case basis.
- The race organiser reserves the right to disqualify the assisted vessel.

6.4 Response Vessel Assistance.

- In the event of a boat requiring assistance from a Response Vessel, the boat shall inform the SO as soon as possible as to the nature of the assistance required.
- The boat shall remain in touch with the SO providing updated information until the situation has been resolved.
- In the event of the boat no longer requiring assistance from a response vessel the boat shall immediately inform the SO.

6.5 Distress.

- In the event of the boat being in DISTRESS, where there is grave and imminent danger to either the boat or the competitors, the EMERGENCY procedures as laid down in the Crisis Operations Plan provided by the race organiser shall be followed.
- The Crisis Operations Plan shall be provided to all teams in soft copy in September and in hard copy during the pre-race period in La Gomera.

6.6 Advice at Sea.

- Crews are not to take emergency advice prior to or contrary to the emergency services or the SO, except from a Marine Rescue Coordination Centre (MRCC).

6.7 External Trainers and Service Providers.

- If teams wish to use an external trainer, information **MUST** be provided to AC in before engaging their services.

6.8 Media and content sent from sea

- All teams must send all content from sea, whether via BGAN, Starlink or any other device through the WTR media approvals process prior to publishing anything on crew or personal social media channels.

7. FINISH

7.1 Rocket Flares.

The firing of rocket and/or parachute flares at the finish, or at any time during the crossing including entering English Harbour, for reason other than emergency may result in disqualification.

7.2 Results.

In the race results, boats will be ranked in time order, subject to any rule infringement penalties being applied.

7.3 Finish Procedures.

All crews will be issued a finish procedure by sat phone at the 20 miles to go SO phone call. This procedure must be adhered to, failure to do so may result in disqualification.

8. RACE NUMBER

8.1 Race Number.

- The race number shall be displayed on the boat in the designated positions as indicated on the Branding Diagram (Appendix 3). The race number will be allocated, delivered, and applied by AC in La Gomera during the pre-race period. This area is to be left clear of logos for application of race number in the pre-race period.

9. RACE BRANDING

9.1 Race Branding

- The boat shall display the race branding, race organiser and additional sponsors logos in the designated positions as indicated on the Branding Diagram (Appendix 3), throughout the duration of the race. Any boat removing or obscuring these logos will be subject to the following penalties:
- Any second hand/ready branded boats will have the quality of the race branding assessed at PSI and crews may be required to remove any branding deemed substandard by the inspecting officer prior to shipping.

10. RACE TIMING AND PROTESTS

10.1 Timing.

- Each team is entitled to protest another team within 48 hours of finishing the race if they believe a rule has been broken.

10.2 Procedure.

- The intention to protest is to be submitted to the race organiser as soon as the rule has been broken and backed up in writing within 48 hours of the protesters finishing.
- A written protest shall be signed and agreed by all members of the protesting team.

10.3 Fee.

- There shall be a fee of €200 to lodge a formal protest.

11. PENALTIES & DISQUALIFICATION

11.1 Late Arrival in San Sebastian.

- Late arrival in San Sebastian by crew members individually, the whole crew, or the vessel, and not being available for pre-race inspections may incur a 24hr time penalty or race disqualification.

11.2 Start Infringement.

- Premature starts, failure to meet timings and interference with other vessels shall incur the following penalties
- Any boat or crew not present at, or late for the race start will incur a 24-hour penalty or race disqualification.
- A crew failing to follow instructions from race officials may receive a time penalty as decided by the race organiser.

- A boat failing to start on time will be held until all other vessels have started and incur a 24hr time penalty.
 - A boat crossing the start line before being told to do so will incur a 24-hour penalty or race disqualification.
- 11.3 Unauthorised Use of Emergency Drinking or Ballast Water.
- On inspection in Antigua, any seals found broken on ballast water may incur a time penalty of 24 hours. A boat may lose a minimum of 2 race positions.
On inspection in Antigua, any seals found broken on emergency water above the amount permitted by the SO during the race may incur a time penalty of 24 hours. A boat may lose a minimum of 2 race positions.
- 11.4 Tampering with a Tracking Unit.
- If a boat is found to have disconnected or purposely damaged the tracking unit, the boat may be disqualified.
- 11.5 Missing Life Saving Equipment.
- If, after inspection in Antigua, any of the mandatory lifesaving equipment as defined in the Mandatory Equipment List is found to be absent, the team may be disqualified from the race, unless it was used for safety purposes.
- 11.6 Failure to Retain Food Packaging.
- Any team that discards food packaging and general packaging at sea may be disqualified.
- 11.7 Behaviour in Port.
- Crews conducting themselves in a dangerous manner, or in such a way to jeopardise the race or its reputation will face penalties. This will be dealt with on a case-by-case basis and may range from a penalty to disqualification and any combination as deemed suitable by AC. AC reserve the right to ask any crew member to participate in a drugs test during the pre or post-race period.
- 11.8 Raising or flying of flags and/or similar items whilst racing.
- Any crew flying a flag (other than flags provided by AC) at any time may face time penalty or disqualification.
- 11.9 Use of Flares.
- Crews firing flares for reasons other than emergencies or after being instructed to by AC may face time penalty or disqualification.
- 11.10 Other means of Propulsion
- Crews using any means of propulsion other than rowing will face immediate disqualification. If evidence becomes available post-race disqualification may happen retrospectively.
- 11.11 Receiving resupply or assistance from any other vessel
- Crews found to have received resupply or assistance from any other vessel during the crossing may face a penalty including a time penalty or disqualification at the discretion of the race organiser.
- 11.12 Obscuring or removing race branding
- Crews found to have purposefully obstructed, altered, covered or removed any race branding may face a penalty including a time penalty or disqualification at the discretion of the race organiser.

11.13 Content and media published without WTR approval

- Crews/social media managers seen to publish content from sea during the race period without clearance from AC may be penalised.

First offence – written warning

Subsequent offences – Time penalties

11.14 Safety at Sea

- Crews seen to be contravening basic safety at sea measures (clipped to jackstays, hatches closed etc) may be penalised.

First offence – written/verbal warning

Subsequent offences – Time penalties

Repeat offences may result in disqualification